Sword' was either imported directly from India or was made using Indian techniques.

Just as in South-East Asia, there was a large diaspora of Indian merchants along the ports of the Arabian Sea and the Persian Gulf as well as in inland trading towns. Abu Zayd reports in the ninth century that 'Hindus came to Siraf and when an Arab merchant invites them to a feast, their numbers often approach or exceed a hundred'. [5] Similarly, Arab merchants came in large numbers to the ports along India's western coast. The famous Arab historian and geographer, Masudi tells us that Indian kings welcomed the traders and allowed them to build their own mosques. He tells us of a particularly large settlement of ten thousand Muslims in the district of Saymur where immigrants from Oman, Basra, Siraf and Baghdad had permanently settled. Farther south, there were a number of Arab settlements in Kerala where they mixed with local converts. Their descendants, called the Moplahs or Mappilas, account for a quarter of the state's population today [6] . By a reversal of fortune, since the 1970s, they have been going in large numbers to work in the oil-rich Arab states. Thus, the churn of people continues.

Meanwhile, farther north, Gujarat came to host the last remnants of the once-powerful Zoroastrian tradition. As discussed in Chapter 2, the origins of this tradition are closely linked to the Rig Vedic people. For fifteen hundred years or more, Zoroastrianism was the dominant religion of Persia. However, it went into sharp decline after the Islamic conquest. A small group escaped persecution and sailed to Gujarat in the eighth century. According to the *Qissa-i Sanjan*, [7] the local Hindu king allowed them to settle on the condition that they adopt the local language (Gujarati) and cease to bear arms. They were otherwise allowed full freedom in religious matters. Their descendants, known as Parsis, migrated to Mumbai in the nineteenth century to repair and build ships for the British. Some of them sailed to British-controlled Hong Kong and made large profits from participating in the opium trade with China. The Parsis then ploughed the money back into building large commercial and industrial businesses back